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CUET UG

Political Science

Globalisation and Its Critics

Unit VII · Political, Economic & Cultural Dimensions, Resistance & India's Reforms · CUET UG 2027 Mastery

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Concept Notes

INSIDE
Solved Examples

INSIDE
Practice MCQs + Solutions

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Syllabus Alignment & Chapter Architecture

Sub-Topic Domain	Official NTA CUET UG Unit VII Syllabus Scope	High-Frequency Cognitive Skills Tested
What is Globalisation?	Concept of globalisation as multidimensional; core flows: ideas, capital, commodities, people; historical catalysts: telecommunications, microprocessors, Internet, container shipping.	Deconstructing multidimensionality; differentiating single-cause myths from systemic technological drivers; analyzing the four transnational flows.
Political Consequences	Erosion vs enhancement of state capacity; rise of the 'minimalist state' (retreat from welfare functions to core defense/law & order); digital empowerment of state surveillance and administration; enduring supremacy of state sovereignty.	Evaluating shifts in sovereign state functions; contrasting neoliberal deregulation with state surveillance capabilities.
Economic Consequences	Free trade and deregulation; role of WTO, IMF, World Bank; unequal distribution of gains (affluent elites vs marginalized labor); erosion of social safety nets; intellectual property rights (TRIPS) and corporate monopolies.	Analyzing asymmetric globalization; evaluating winners vs losers; assessing the impact of economic conditionalities on developing nations.
Cultural Consequences	Cultural homogenisation: Americanisation, Westernisation, consumerist monoculture ("McDonaldization", blue jeans); cultural heterogenisation: creative fusion, cultural hybridity (khadi kurta over jeans, ethnic culinary adaptation).	Distinguishing cultural homogenization from heterogenization; evaluating impacts on indigenous languages and local traditions.
India and Globalisation	Colonial legacy of resource drain; post-1947 protectionism and Import Substitution Industrialisation (ISI); 1991 New Economic Policy (LPG: Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation); sectoral impacts (IT boom vs agrarian distress).	Tracing India's economic trajectory from autarky to outward orientation; evaluating socio-economic impacts of 1991 reforms.
Resistance to Globalisation	Critiques from the Left (neoliberal exploitation, corporate greed, destruction of welfare) and Right (cultural pollution, loss of traditional family values); anti-WTO protests (Seattle 1999); World Social Forum (WSF, Porto Alegre 2001, Mumbai 2004).	Evaluating political critiques of globalization; tracing anti-globalization mobilization timelines; analyzing social movement solidarity.

CUET HIGH-SCORING INSIGHT & KEY COGNITIVE TRAPS

Theme 7 requires clear conceptual distinctions between political, economic, and cultural dynamics:

1. **The Multidimensional Nature of Globalisation:**
   - Globalisation is NOT solely an economic phenomenon; it possesses interconnected **political, economic, and cultural** dimensions.

- Driven by **four interconnected flows**: ideas, capital, commodities, and people (labor movement is the most restricted!).

2. **Political Dialectic (Minimalist State vs Surveillance State):**
   - State retreats from **welfare functions** (health, education, food subsidies).
   - But state capacity is **enhanced** through modern digital surveillance, big data, and administrative tracking.
3. **Cultural Dialectic (Homogenisation vs Heterogenisation):**
   - **Homogenisation:** Spread of Western monoculture ("McDonaldization", cultural uniformity).
   - **Heterogenisation:** External influences are creatively combined with local culture to produce **unique fusions** (e.g. Khadi kurta with blue jeans).
4. **Anti-Globalisation Milestones:**
   - **Battle of Seattle (1999):** Massive protests at the 3rd WTO Ministerial Conference.
   - **World Social Forum (WSF):** First held in **Porto Alegre, Brazil (2001)**; motto: "Another World is Possible".
   - **4th WSF Meeting:** Held in **Mumbai, India (2004)**.
5. **India's Economic Shift:**
   - 1947–1991: Protectionism & Import Substitution Industrialisation (ISI).
   - **1991:** New Economic Policy under P.V. Narasimha Rao & Dr. Manmohan Singh (LPG reforms).

1. The Concept and Catalysts of Contemporary Globalisation

At its most fundamental conceptual core, **globalisation** is the intensification of worldwide social, economic, and political relations that link distant localities in such a way that local happenings are shaped by events occurring many thousands of miles away:

Globalisation as a Multidimensional Reality

A prevalent misconception assumes that globalisation is exclusively an economic phenomenon driven by free-market capitalism. In reality, globalisation is inherently **multidimensional**, simultaneously transforming:

- **1. The Political Domain:** Redefining the sovereignty, responsibilities, and operational reach of the nation-state.
- **2. The Economic Domain:** Accelerating the cross-border integration of national markets, investments, and production supply chains.
- **3. The Cultural Domain:** Altering everyday lifestyles, consumer preferences, artistic expressions, and value systems worldwide.

The Four Interconnected Transnational Flows

Globalisation operates through four fundamental vectors of cross-border mobility:

- **1. Flow of Ideas:** The frictionless, instantaneous transmission of philosophical concepts, scientific discoveries, democratic norms, and political ideologies across the planet.
- **2. Flow of Capital:** The massive, 24/7 electronic movement of financial capital, foreign direct investment (FDI), and portfolio investments between global stock exchanges.

- **3. Flow of Commodities:** The vast physical circulation of manufactured goods, raw materials, agricultural products, and energy resources across oceans and borders, facilitated by container shipping and lowered customs tariffs.
- **4. Flow of People:** The cross-border migration of individuals in search of employment, education, or asylum. **Crucial Exam Insight:** In contemporary global politics, the flow of people (labor) remains the **most heavily restricted and policed** flow, as wealthy developed nations erect formidable visa barriers and border fortifications while demanding unrestricted entry for their own capital and commodities.

The Technological Driver

While human history has witnessed prior waves of international contact (through ancient silk routes, religious pilgrimages, and European colonial empires), contemporary globalisation is qualitatively unprecedented because of the **digital technological revolution**:

- Inventions such as the telegraph, telephone, microchip, personal computer, fiber-optic telecommunication cables, and the World Wide Web created the infrastructure for real-time global connectivity.
- Events occurring in one corner of the globe—whether a banking panic on Wall Street, a political uprising in the Middle East, or a viral epidemic in East Asia—reverberate worldwide almost instantaneously.

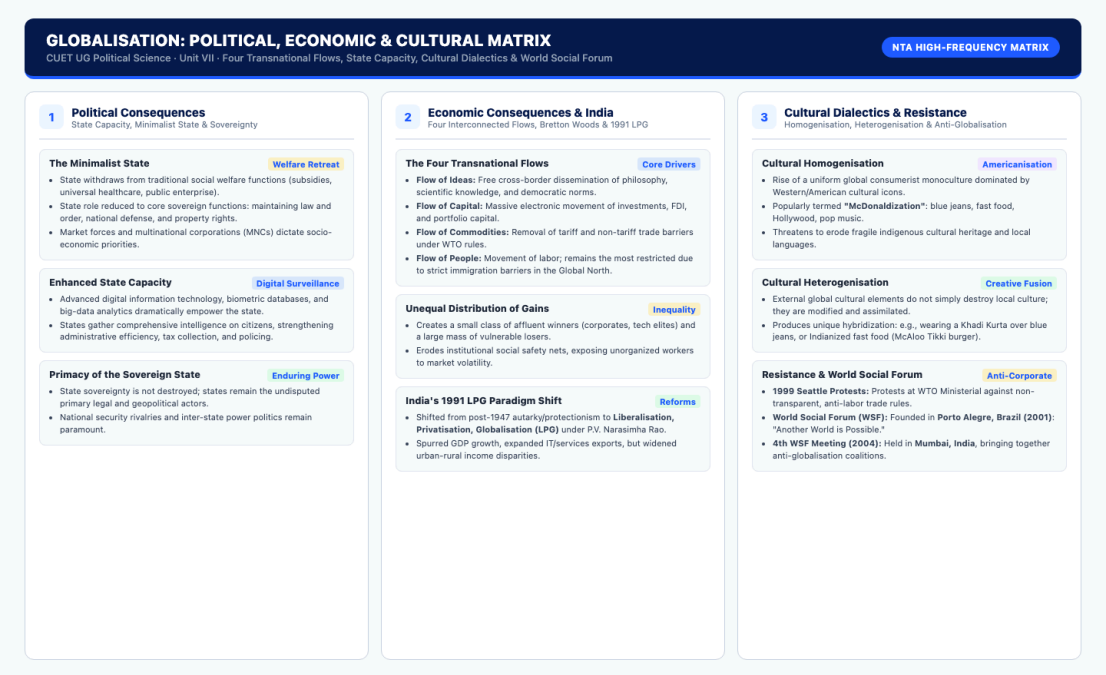


Figure 1: Figure 1 — Globalisation Architectural Matrix: The four transnational flows, political transformation of state capacity, cultural dialectics, and global resistance movements.

2. Political Consequences of Globalisation: State Capacity & Sovereignty

How does globalization impact the sovereign power, administrative capacity, and traditional functions of the modern nation-state?

The Retreat to the Minimalist State

- **Erosion of the Welfare Model:** Under the pressure of global capital mobility and international financial institutions (IMF and World Bank), sovereign governments are compelled to slash corporate taxes and eliminate social subsidies.
- **The Minimalist State:** The state largely withdraws from traditional socio-economic welfare interventions (such as state-run healthcare, public higher education, guaranteed employment, and subsidized food distribution).
- **Core Sovereign Remnants:** The state's primary role is reduced to maintaining domestic law and order, ensuring physical national defense, and enforcing private commercial contracts and property rights. The market and private multinational corporations become the primary arbiters of socio-economic priorities.

The Technological Enhancement of State Capacity

Paradoxically, globalisation does not merely weaken the nation-state; in critical respects, it significantly **augments and empowers state capacity**:

- **Advanced Surveillance & Data Systems:** Breakthroughs in digital information technology, biometric identification databases, satellite surveillance, and artificial intelligence provide governments with unprecedented capabilities to monitor, track, and police their citizenry.
- **Administrative Efficiency:** Digital governance dramatically improves tax collection mechanisms, border management, and national security intelligence sharing.
- **Enduring Primacy of the State:** State sovereignty is far from extinct. In matters of national security, foreign policy, and immigration control, sovereign nation-states remain the undisputed preeminent actors on the global stage.



Figure 2: Figure 2 — Thematic Chronology & Globalisation Dynamics Architecture: Political state transformations, economic flow mechanics, cultural homogenisation vs heterogenisation, and India's LPG timeline.

3. Economic Consequences of Globalisation: Gains, Asymmetries & Cleavages

Economic globalisation involves the growing economic interdependence of countries worldwide through the increasing volume and variety of cross-border transactions in goods, services, and international capital flows:

The Mechanisms of Economic Integration

- **Trade Liberalization:** Systematically reducing import tariffs, export duties, and quantitative quotas under the regulatory oversight of the World Trade Organization (WTO).
- **Financial Deregulation:** Dismantling domestic exchange controls to permit multinational corporations (MNCs) to invest capital and repatriate corporate profits freely.
- **Global Supply Chains:** Manufacturing components across multiple countries to maximize labor cost advantages (e.g., consumer electronics designed in the US, assembled in East Asia, using mineral inputs from Africa).

Asymmetries and the Growing Socio-Economic Divide

Economic globalization has produced deep, contentious social cleavages within and between nations:

- **Concentration of Wealth:** A small, affluent segment of society—multinational corporate executives, financial speculators, high-tech entrepreneurs, and specialized service professionals—reaps immense financial rewards.
- **Vulnerability of Marginalized Populations:** In contrast, millions of smallholder farmers, traditional artisans, unorganized factory laborers, and indigenous communities face acute livelihood displacement due to cheap subsidized agricultural imports and corporate land acquisitions.
- **Erosion of Social Safety Nets:** While European social democracies retained robust unemployment insurance, developing nations entered the globalized economy with rudimentary safety nets, exposing vulnerable citizens to sudden global economic shocks.

4. Cultural Consequences: Homogenisation vs Heterogenisation

One of the most intensely debated aspects of globalization is its transformative impact on local cultures, indigenous traditions, and societal value systems:

Cultural Homogenisation: The Threat of Cultural Monoculture

- **Definition:** The process whereby distinctive local cultures, regional customs, and national artistic traditions are gradually eroded and superseded by a uniform, standardized global consumer culture.
- **Americanisation & Western Dominance:** Because the United States and Western Europe command overwhelming dominance over global mass media, film distribution (Hollywood), pop music, and television broadcasting, cultural homogenization is widely perceived as the westernization of the world.
- **The "McDonaldization" of Society:** Sociologist George Ritzer coined the term to describe the global spread of standardized corporate efficiency, predictability, and fast-food consumerism. The ubiquity of American cultural symbols—such as blue jeans, fast-food burger chains, Hollywood superhero blockbusters, and commercial holiday celebrations—threatens to extinguish rich indigenous cultural diversity.

Cultural Heterogenisation: Hybridity and Creative Fusion

- **The Counter-Tendency:** Sociological research demonstrates that globalization does not simply obliterate local culture through one-way Western cultural imperialism.
- **Creative Hybridity:** When external cultural products encounter local societies, local communities actively appropriate, modify, and assimilate them into their own cultural contexts:
  - **Fashion Fusion:** A young Indian wearing a handspun traditional **Khadi kurta** over American blue jeans embodies creative cultural hybridization.
  - **Culinary Adaptation:** Global fast-food corporations are compelled to fundamentally alter their menus to cater to local palates (e.g., Indian vegetarian fast-food options like McAloo Tikki, or blending Indian spices with Italian pizza).
- **Enriching Distinctiveness:** Instead of producing a sterile, uniform monoculture, cultural heterogenization ensures that every culture becomes more distinctive, complex, and heterogeneous through cross-cultural contact.

5. India and the Trajectory of Globalisation

India's historical engagement with the global economy reflects dramatic ideological shifts, from colonial exploitation to post-independence autarky and finally to aggressive outward liberalization:

Historical Context: From Colonial Plunder to Protectionism

- **The Colonial Experience:** Under British imperial rule, India was transformed from a premier global exporter of high-quality manufactured textiles into a captive supplier of agricultural raw materials (cotton, jute, tea, indigo) and a captive market for British manufactured commodities. This massive transfer of wealth (**the drain of wealth**) impoverished the nation.
- **Post-Independence Import Substitution (1947–1991):**
  - Haunted by colonial economic subjugation, Jawaharlal Nehru and early economic planners chose a strategy of **economic self-reliance**.
  - Adopted **Import Substitution Industrialisation (ISI)**, imposing prohibitive tariffs, quantitative quotas, and industrial licensing (**the License Raj**) to protect infant domestic industries from foreign corporate dominance.
  - While this strategy created a diversified domestic heavy industrial base, it generated sluggish economic growth (the proverbial "Hindu rate of growth" of 3.5%), chronic inefficiencies, technological obsolescence, and bureaucratic corruption.

The 1991 Paradigm Shift: The LPG Reforms

- **The Balance-of-Payments Crisis (1991):**
  - Triggered by soaring crude oil prices during the 1990–91 Gulf War, the collapse of Soviet-bloc trade, and dwindling foreign exchange reserves (barely enough to finance three weeks of essential imports).
  - India was forced to airlift gold reserves to London to secure emergency credit lines from the IMF and World Bank.
- **The New Economic Policy:** Under Prime Minister **P.V. Narasimha Rao** and Finance Minister **Dr. Manmohan Singh**, India launched the historic **LPG Reforms**:
  - **Liberalisation:** Abolished industrial licensing, deregulated commercial interest rates, and eased foreign trade tariffs.
  - **Privatisation:** Divested state equity in public sector enterprises (PSUs) and encouraged private enterprise.

- **Globalisation:** Opened key sectors of the Indian economy to Foreign Direct Investment (FDI), reformed currency exchange controls, and integrated India into global supply chains.
- **Consequences for India:** The reforms accelerated annual GDP growth to over 7–8%, fueled a massive boom in the Information Technology (IT) and Business Process Outsourcing (BPO) service export sectors, and expanded a prosperous urban middle class. However, it also exacerbated regional disparities between industrialized southern/western states and rural agrarian heartlands, while public investment in agriculture stagnated.

6. Resistance to Globalisation: Ideological Critiques & Social Movements

Globalisation has not advanced unopposed; across the globe, diverse social coalitions have organized fierce resistance against corporate-dominated economic models:

The Ideological Critiques: Left vs Right

- **The Leftist Critique:**
  - Argues that contemporary globalisation represents a virulent phase of **neoliberal global capitalism** that enriches wealthy corporate elites while impoverishing the working class.
  - Denounces the systematic dismantling of the social welfare state, privatization of public healthcare and education, and environmental devastation caused by transnational extractive corporations.
  - Points out that international trade rules under the WTO are heavily rigged in favor of advanced Western economies.
- **The Rightist Critique:**
  - Expresses profound alarm over the erosion of traditional national cultural values, indigenous heritage, religious morality, and family structures caused by Western commercial hedonism.
  - Demands the reassertion of national sovereignty, cultural purity, and patriotic economic protectionism against globalizing institutions.

Landmark Anti-Globalisation Mobilisations

- **The 1999 Seattle Protests ("Battle of Seattle"):**
  - In November 1999, tens of thousands of trade unionists, environmentalists, student activists, and indigenous groups paralyzed the 3rd Ministerial Conference of the WTO in Seattle, Washington.
  - Protesters targeted the WTO's undemocratic, non-transparent decision-making processes and its prioritization of multinational corporate profits over labor rights and ecological sustainability.
- **The World Social Forum (WSF):**
  - Founded in **Porto Alegre, Brazil, in January 2001** as a global counter-hegemonic assembly to rival the elite World Economic Forum (WEF) held annually in Davos, Switzerland.
  - United human rights campaigners, peasant organizations, trade unions, feminist networks, and environmentalists under the inspiring global banner: **"Another World is Possible"**.
  - **The 4th WSF Gathering in Mumbai (2004):** In January 2004, the 4th World Social Forum convened in **Mumbai, India**, drawing over 100,000 delegates from across the globe to build cross-border coalitions against imperialist wars, caste discrimination, and corporate economic exploitation.

7. The Anti-Globalisation Movement in India

In India, resistance to neoliberal globalization has mobilized diverse grassroots constituencies:

- **Trade Union Opposition:** Major central trade unions organized nationwide general strikes protesting the privatization of public sector undertakings (PSUs), labor law deregulation, and privatization of nationalized commercial banks.
- **Agrarian Protests:** Farmers' organizations protested against multinational seed monopolies (patenting of indigenous seeds such as basmati and neem), withdrawal of agricultural electricity subsidies, and WTO agricultural agreements.
- **Cultural Resistance:** Right-wing cultural organizations staged protests against the commercialization of Western cultural events (such as Valentine's Day celebrations) and international beauty pageants.

8. Intellectual Property Wars, TRIPS & Biopiracy in Developing Nations

A central battleground in economic globalization revolves around the global regime of intellectual property rights administered by the World Trade Organization:

The TRIPS Agreement and Knowledge Monopolies

- **The TRIPS Mandate:** Negotiated during the Uruguay Round, the **Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS)** agreement established globally harmonized minimum standards for patents, copyrights, trademarks, and industrial designs.
- **Impact on Developing Economies:**
  - Industrialized Western nations historically utilized loose patent regimes during their own industrial rise. However, TRIPS imposed stringent 20-year product patents, prohibiting developing nations from reverse-engineering expensive foreign pharmaceuticals.
  - **The Public Health Dilemma:** Stringent patent enforcement drastically increased the price of essential life-saving medications (such as HIV/AIDS antiretroviral drugs). At the **2001 WTO Ministerial in Doha**, developing nations successfully fought for the **Doha Declaration on TRIPS and Public Health**, affirming that international patent rules must not prevent governments from taking measures to protect public health through compulsory licensing and parallel imports of generic drugs.

Biopiracy and the Defense of Traditional Knowledge

Developing nations rich in biodiversity—such as India—have faced systematic corporate attempts by Western multinational corporations to patent indigenous biological resources and ancient traditional knowledge:

- **The Turmeric (Haldi) Patent Battle:** In 1995, the US Patent and Trademark Office granted a patent to the University of Mississippi for the wound-healing properties of turmeric. The Indian Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) launched a legal challenge, presenting ancient Sanskrit Ayurvedic texts proving that turmeric's medicinal utility had been known in India for millennia. The patent was fully revoked in 1997.
- **The Basmati Rice and Neem Disputes:** Similar high-profile patent disputes erupted over Texas-based RiceTec patenting cross-bred "Texmati" rice lines, and American corporate patents on the fungicidal properties of Neem extract, both successfully challenged by Indian civil society and scientific institutions.

- **Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL):** In response to biopiracy, India created the world's first comprehensive digital database documenting ancient medicinal formulations in multiple international languages to prevent foreign corporate misappropriation.

9. The Concept of 'Glocalisation' and Cultural Hybridity

In contemporary sociology and political science, the interaction between global forces and local societies is increasingly analyzed through the lens of **Glocalisation**:

- **Definition:** Coined by British sociologist **Roland Robertson**, glocalisation denotes the simultaneous occurrence of universalizing and particularizing tendencies, where global products and ideas are tailored to suit local specificities.
- **Dynamic Cultural Negotiations:** Far from passively absorbing Western values, local societies creatively reshape external cultural artifacts:
  - **Media & Entertainment:** Global satellite networks (such as MTV and Star TV) originally attempted to broadcast English-language Western programming in India. When viewing ratings plummeted, they were forced to "Indianize" their content, developing Hindi-language music channels, regional soap operas, and local comedy shows.
  - **Consumer Products:** International fast-food corporations completely eliminated beef and pork products from Indian menus, introducing separate vegetarian kitchens and developing unique spice blends that exist nowhere else in the world.

10. The Deglobalisation Debate & India's Strategic Self-Reliance

In the aftermath of the 2008 global financial crash, rising geopolitical rivalries, and the profound economic disruptions caused by the COVID-19 pandemic, scholars began debating whether the world had entered an era of **Deglobalisation**:

- **Fragility of Extended Supply Chains:** The pandemic exposed the extreme vulnerability of hyper-globalized supply chains. When national lockdowns paralyzed Chinese manufacturing hubs, global automobile, electronics, and pharmaceutical industries ground to an abrupt halt due to shortages of microchips and active pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs).
- **Rise of Economic Nationalism:** Major world powers increasingly embraced protective industrial policies, "near-shoring" (relocating production closer to home), and "friend-shoring" (restricting critical trade to geopolitical allies).
- **India's "Atmanirbhar Bharat" (Self-Reliant India):**
  - Launched in May 2020 in the wake of the pandemic, India's self-reliance strategy rejects a return to the pre-1991 autarkic import substitution model.
  - Instead, it seeks to build robust domestic manufacturing capacities through **Production Linked Incentive (PLI)** schemes across strategic sectors (electronics, pharmaceuticals, solar panels, and defense manufacturing) so that India integrates into global value chains from a position of technological strength rather than vulnerable dependency.

11. South-South Multilateralism & Plurilateral Economic Groupings

In response to Western hegemony within the Bretton Woods institutions, emerging market economies have established alternative plurilateral financial and political platforms:

- **The BRICS Forum:** Comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa (expanded in 2024 to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE). BRICS promotes a multipolar international financial order, advocating for greater voting rights in the IMF and exploring local currency settlement mechanisms to reduce vulnerability to US dollar weaponization.

- **The New Development Bank (NDB):** Established by the 2014 Fortaleza Declaration of BRICS, headquartered in Shanghai, China. Unlike the World Bank, the NDB operates on the principle of equal sovereign shareholding, financing green infrastructure projects across developing nations without imposing austerity conditionalities.

12. India's Strategic Balancing: The FTA Experience and RCEP Exit

India's ongoing engagement with regional trade globalization reflects a cautious, pragmatic calculus aimed at protecting domestic manufacturing and agriculture:

- **Free Trade Agreements (FTAs):** In the 2000s, India concluded comprehensive economic partnership agreements with ASEAN, Japan, and South Korea. However, domestic manufacturing sectors experienced widening trade deficits, as cheap imports surged while non-tariff barriers restricted Indian exports.
- **The RCEP Decision (November 2019):**
  - The **Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP)** was negotiated as a massive mega-regional trade bloc encompassing ASEAN and its dialogue partners.
  - In November 2019 at the Bangkok Summit, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced India's definitive decision to walk out of RCEP.
  - **Strategic Justifications:** India cited core unresolved concerns: the lack of adequate safeguard mechanisms against import surges from China, refusal to grant market access for Indian service professionals and IT exports, and the threat of cheap agricultural and dairy dumping that would jeopardize the livelihoods of over 100 million Indian dairy and smallholder farmers.

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Chapter Synthesis & Cognitive Mindmap



Figure 3: Figure 3 — Globalisation and Its Critics Summary Mindmap: Complete structural map of the four flows, political minimalist state, cultural homogenisation vs heterogenisation, 1991 LPG reforms, and the World Social Forum.

HIGH-YIELD MEMORY HOOKS & HISTORIOGRAPHICAL POINTERS

- **Multidimensionality:** Globalisation is **political, economic, and cultural**—NOT solely economic.
- **The Four Flows:** Ideas, Capital, Commodities, and **People** (movement of people/labor is the **most restricted**).
- **Political Dialectic:** Creates a **Minimalist State** (retreat from welfare) while **enhancing** state surveillance capacity.
- **Cultural Dialectic: Homogenisation** (Western monoculture, McDonaldization) vs **Heterogenisation** (creative local fusion).
- **India's Economic Turning Point: 1991** New Economic Policy (LPG: Liberalisation, Privatisation, Globalisation).
- **Import Substitution (ISI):** India's post-1947 autarkic model before 1991 reforms.
- **Seattle Protests (1999):** Mass anti-WTO demonstrations exposed corporate bias.
- **World Social Forum (WSF):** First held in **Porto Alegre, Brazil (2001)**; motto: **"Another World is Possible"**.
- **4th WSF Meeting (2004):** Held in **Mumbai, India**, mobilizing over 100,000 global activists.
- **Left vs Right Critiques:** Left focuses on **economic inequality and welfare retreat**; Right focuses on **cultural and moral pollution**.

MASTER STRATEGY CHEATSHEET — GLOBALISATION & ITS CRITICS

▸**Core Foundations:** Multidimensionality (political, economic, cultural). Core catalyst = digital revolution & microprocessors. ▸**Four Flows Framework:** 1. Ideas (frictionless) → 2. Capital (electronic FDI) → 3. Commodities (global trade/WTO) → 4. People (most restricted by state borders). ▸**Political Consequences:** Minimalist State (sheds welfare, maintains defense/law & order) → Enhanced capacity (digital intelligence, big data surveillance) → Sovereignty endures. ▸**Cultural Dialectics:** Homogenisation (Americanisation, McDonaldization, consumerism) vs Heterogenisation (hybridity, khadi kurta with blue jeans, ethnic food adaptations). ▸**India's Paradigm Shifts:** 1947–1991: Protectionism & Import Substitution (ISI) → 1991: Balance of Payments crisis → LPG Reforms (Rao & Manmohan Singh) → Outward growth. ▸**Global Anti-Globalisation Front:** 1999 Seattle WTO Ministerial Protests → World Social Forum (WSF, 2001 Porto Alegre, Brazil) → 4th WSF (2004 Mumbai, India) → "Another World is Possible".

THE SEVEN FATAL CUET TRAPS

1. **Trap 1 (Globalisation as Purely Economic):** Assuming globalisation is only about trade. It is strictly **multidimensional** (political, economic, cultural).
2. **Trap 2 (State Sovereignty Myth):** Believing the sovereign state has been destroyed by globalization. States retain paramount power and have enhanced surveillance tools.
3. **Trap 3 (The Most Restricted Flow):** The flow of **people / labor** is the most heavily restricted flow, NOT capital or commodities.
4. **Trap 4 (Homogenisation vs Heterogenisation):** Homogenisation creates **uniform Western monoculture**; heterogenisation produces **creative cultural fusions and hybridity**.
5. **Trap 5 (WSF Founding Year and City):** WSF was founded in **2001 in Porto Alegre, Brazil**, NOT in Seattle (1999) or Mumbai (2004).
6. **Trap 6 (Mumbai WSF Meeting Edition):** The Mumbai meeting in 2004 was the **4th World Social Forum**, NOT the 1st or 2nd.
7. **Trap 7 (Leftist vs Rightist Critique):** The Left opposes globalisation due to **economic inequality and corporate greed**; the Right opposes it due to **cultural contamination and loss of traditional values**.

Exam-Style Practice Questions & Detailed Solutions

Part 1: Four Flows, Minimalist State & Cultural Dialectics (Q1 to Q5)

Q1. At its core conceptual level, globalization is best understood as a multidimensional phenomenon involving the cross-border interconnectedness of which four fundamental flows?

(A) Weapons, Treaties, Diplomats, and Military Forces
(B) Ideas, Capital, Commodities, and People
(C) Currencies, Tariffs, Ships, and Passports
(D) Governments, Religions, Languages, and Borders

Sol. Q1. The Four Fundamental Flows:

- Globalisation is defined in political science as the interconnectedness generated through the cross-border movement of four primary flows: **ideas, capital, commodities, and people**.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q2. What technological advancement is recognized in political science as the single most critical historical catalyst enabling contemporary rapid globalization?

(A) The invention of the steam locomotive in 1804
(B) The construction of the Panama Canal in 1914
(C) Inventions in telecommunications, microprocessors, and the Internet
(D) The discovery of commercial electricity in 1882

Sol. Q2. Technological Catalyst of Globalisation:

- Breakthroughs in **telecommunications, microprocessors, satellite communication, and the Internet** dismantled physical distance, allowing instantaneous planetary communication and capital transfers.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q3. In the political sphere, the retreat of the state from social welfare expenditures and public services in favor of market mechanisms is described as the emergence of the:

(A) Minimalist State
(B) Authoritarian State
(C) Totalitarian State
(D) Feudal State

Sol. Q3. Concept of the Minimalist State:

- Under neoliberal globalization, the state sheds broad socio-economic welfare functions, becoming a **minimalist state** restricted to maintaining law and order, national defense, and property rights.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q4. Despite economic globalization, which of the four fundamental transnational flows remains the most heavily restricted by national state border controls?

(A) The cross-border movement of financial capital
(B) The electronic transmission of digital data and ideas
(C) The shipping of industrial manufactured commodities
(D) The cross-border movement of labor and people

Sol. Q4. Restrictions on the Flow of People:

- While capital and commodities move with increasing freedom, sovereign states (especially in the Global North) enforce strict visa restrictions, making the **movement of people/labor** the most restricted flow.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q5. The cultural phenomenon whereby global consumerism leads to the rise of a uniform, Westernized global monoculture (such as fast food and blue jeans) is termed:

(A) Cultural Heterogenisation
(B) Cultural Homogenisation
(C) Cultural Relativism
(D) Cultural Renaissance

Sol. Q5. Cultural Homogenisation:

- **Cultural homogenisation** refers to the spread of a standardized, Western/Americanized monoculture (popularly dubbed "McDonaldization") that threatens to erode distinct indigenous cultures.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Part 2: Cultural Fusion, 1991 LPG Reforms & Seattle Protests (Q6 to Q10)

Q6. Cultural heterogenisation, the counter-tendency to cultural homogenization in a globalizing world, refers to the process whereby external cultural elements:

(A) Are selectively modified and combined with local traditions to produce unique cultural fusions
(B) Are completely eradicated through violent religious resistance
(C) Eradicate all indigenous languages and historical customs permanently
(D) Force all sovereign nation-states to adopt uniform national dress codes

Sol. Q6. Concept of Cultural Heterogenisation:

- **Cultural heterogenisation** occurs when global cultural elements are adopted by local societies, modified, and combined with local traditions to produce unique cultural fusions (e.g. khadi kurta over jeans).

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q7. In which year did the Government of India formally abandon its post-independence protectionist economic regime to inaugurate the New Economic Policy of Liberalisation, Privatisation, and Globalisation (LPG)?

(A) 1984
(B) 1991
(C) 1998
(D) 2004

Sol. Q7. The 1991 LPG Economic Reforms:

- In **July 1991**, amidst a severe balance-of-payments crisis, Prime Minister P.V. Narasimha Rao and Finance Minister Dr. Manmohan Singh initiated the landmark **LPG economic reforms**.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q8. In November 1999, historic mass street protests erupted against the non-transparent, corporate-friendly negotiating agendas of the World Trade Organization (WTO) in which city?

(A) Geneva, Switzerland
(B) Washington, D.C.
(C) Seattle, United States
(D) London, United Kingdom

Sol. Q8. The 1999 Seattle Anti-WTO Protests:

- In **November 1999**, thousands of trade unionists and environmentalists staged the historic "Battle of Seattle" at the 3rd WTO Ministerial Conference, protesting against corporate-dominated trade rules.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q9. The World Social Forum (WSF), a global platform bringing together human rights activists, environmentalists, and labor unions under the motto 'Another World is Possible', held its first meeting in 2001 in:

(A) Porto Alegre, Brazil
(B) Davos, Switzerland
(C) Mumbai, India
(D) Caracas, Venezuela

Sol. Q9. Founding of the World Social Forum (WSF):

- The **World Social Forum (WSF)** held its inaugural gathering in **January 2001 in Porto Alegre, Brazil**, uniting worldwide civil society movements to challenge the elite World Economic Forum in Davos.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q10. In which year and Indian city did the World Social Forum (WSF) convene its historic fourth global gathering, demonstrating mass resistance to neoliberal globalization?

(A) New Delhi, 2001
(B) Mumbai, 2004
(C) Kolkata, 2006
(D) Hyderabad, 2008

Sol. Q10. The 4th WSF Gathering in Mumbai:

- The **4th World Social Forum** took place in **Mumbai, India, in January 2004**, bringing together over 100,000 activists from around the world to protest against imperialist wars and economic exploitation.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Part 3: Left vs Right Critiques, Import Substitution & Digital State (Q11 to Q15)

Q11. Critics of globalization from the political Left primarily argue that contemporary economic globalization leads to:

(A) The loss of traditional patriarchal family values
(B) Excessive government regulation over private industry
(C) Neoliberal capitalist exploitation, erosion of social safety nets, and widening socio-economic inequalities
(D) The immediate military collapse of all sovereign nation-states

Sol. Q11. Leftist Critique of Globalisation:

- The **Leftist critique** emphasizes that neoliberal globalization benefits multinational corporations, slashes social welfare for the impoverished, and dramatically widens socio-economic inequality.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q12. Critics of globalization from the political Right voice deep opposition primarily because globalization threatens:

(A) Corporate profitability and foreign direct investment
(B) The complete abolition of all military armed forces
(C) The privatization of public sector enterprises
(D) Traditional cultural norms, national religious identities, and sovereign self-reliance

Sol. Q12. Rightist Critique of Globalisation:

- The **Rightist critique** focuses on cultural anxieties, warning that Western consumerism contaminates age-old religious values, traditional family structures, and national cultural heritage.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q13. Following independence in 1947, India initially adopted an inward-oriented economic development model characterized by which core industrial strategy?

(A) Import Substitution Industrialisation (ISI)
(B) Export-Oriented Manufacturing (EOM)
(C) Unrestricted Foreign Direct Investment
(D) Laissez-Faire Free-Market Capitalism

Sol. Q13. India's Import Substitution Strategy:

- From 1947 to 1991, India pursued **Import Substitution Industrialisation (ISI)**, using high tariffs, quotas, and heavy state regulation to build domestic manufacturing and protect against foreign dependence.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q14. In cultural theory, the widespread global proliferation of Western commercial culinary habits, standardized corporate efficiency, and consumer branding is popularly known as:

(A) Sanskritisation
(B) Glocalisation
(C) McDonaldization
(D) Secularisation

Sol. Q14. Concept of McDonaldization:

- Coined by sociologist George Ritzer, **McDonaldization** describes the worldwide spread of fast-food corporate efficiency, predictability, and consumer standardization as a hallmark of cultural homogenization.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q15. How has the digital information revolution paradoxically impacted the political capacity of the modern sovereign nation-state?

(A) It has completely eliminated national borders and citizenship laws
(B) It has forced all nation-states to surrender military forces to the UN
(C) It has prevented governments from collecting any income taxes
(D) It has enhanced state capacity by providing surveillance, biometric tracking, and administrative data systems

Sol. Q15. Enhanced State Technological Capacity:

- Advanced digital information technology, biometric surveillance, and big-data systems have **enhanced state capacity**, equipping governments with superior tools to govern, monitor citizens, and protect national security.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**